

RUN-007 - Major Incident (P1) Management Process

Purpose

Define the end-to-end process for identifying, declaring, managing, and resolving a Priority 1 (P1) Major Incident at Summit IT. A P1 represents a critical service outage or security event with significant impact to business operations and requires immediate, coordinated response.

SLA: Response within 15 minutes. Resolution target: 4 hours.

P1 Criteria - When to Declare a Major Incident

Declare a P1 if **any one** of the following is true:

Condition	Examples
Complete outage of a business-critical service	Microsoft 365 down, Okta SSO down, VPN gateway unavailable
More than 50 users unable to work	Widespread email, Teams, or network failure
Active security incident affecting systems	Ransomware, confirmed breach, mass phishing compromise
Core infrastructure failure	Internet circuit down at HQ, data center failure, DNS failure
Executive-level user completely unable to work	C-suite or VP fully impaired with no workaround

When in doubt, declare P1 and downgrade later. It is better to mobilize and stand down than to under-respond.

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility	Filled By
Incident Commander (IC)	Owns the incident end-to-end; makes go/no-go decisions; drives resolution	L2 Lead on duty or L3 on-call

Technical Lead	Leads technical investigation and remediation	L3 Engineer assigned by IC
Communications Lead	Manages stakeholder updates, status page, and internal comms	L2 or designated IT comms contact
SOC Analyst	Security monitoring; involved for all security-related P1s	On-call SOC analyst (soc@summitit.com)
Scribe	Documents timeline, actions, decisions in real time in the INC ticket	L1 or junior L2 on duty
Vendor Liaison	Manages vendor bridge calls if needed	IC or delegate

Procedure

Phase 1: Detection & Declaration (0-15 Minutes)

Step 1. Identify the Incident

P1 incidents are typically detected via: - User reports to Service Desk (phone, Slack #it-help, email) - CrowdStrike alert (Falcon console) - Microsoft 365 health alerts (admin.microsoft.com > Health > Service Health) - Okta admin alert - Automated monitoring alert (Datadog, Azure Monitor) - Palo Alto Panorama alert

Step 2. Triage Quickly

1. Ask 3 questions: - How many users are affected? - Is there a workaround? - Is this a security event?
2. If P1 criteria are met, **do not spend more than 5 minutes triaging before declaring** - declare first, triage in parallel.

Step 3. Declare P1 and Open INC Ticket

1. Create a Major Incident ticket in SummitDesk: - Priority: **P1 - Critical** - Title: Brief, clear description (e.g., "P1 - Microsoft 365 email service unavailable - all users") - Category: Relevant category (e.g., Microsoft 365, Network, Security) - Impacted service(s): List all - Estimated users affected: Your best estimate
2. Note the ticket ID (e.g., INC-009921). This is the single source of truth for the incident.

Step 4. Page the Incident Commander

1. Call the L2 lead on duty. If not available, call the L3 on-call: - On-call rotation pager: +1 (800) 555-7866 x2 (24/7) - Slack: #it-oncall - post@here P1 declared - [INC ticket link]
2. IC acknowledges within 15 minutes. If no acknowledgment in 15 min, escalate up the chain (see escalation-matrix-and-on-call.md).

Step 5. Open the P1 Bridge Call

1. Start a Zoom bridge call immediately: - Zoom link: <https://summitit.zoom.us/j/999001001> (standing P1 bridge - always available) - Passcode: SummitP1
2. Post the bridge link in: - Slack #it-major-incidents (create the channel if the first P1 today): P1 DECLARED - [INC-#####] - [brief description] - Bridge: [Zoom link] - Slack #it-help to inform users: We are aware of an issue affecting [service]. Our team is actively investigating. Updates will follow.

Phase 2: Investigation & Communication (15 Min - 2 Hours)

Step 6. Assign Roles on the Bridge

IC assigns: - Technical Lead - Communications Lead - Scribe - SOC Analyst (for security events)

Step 7. Technical Investigation

The Technical Lead drives investigation:

1. Check external status pages first (before assuming internal cause): - Microsoft 365: <https://status.office365.com> or Admin Center > Service Health - Okta: <https://status.okta.com> - Palo Alto: <https://status.paloaltonetworks.com> - Zoom: <https://status.zoom.us>
2. If it is a vendor-side outage, document the vendor incident ID and move to communication mode - internal fix is not possible.
3. If internal, proceed with targeted investigation per the affected system.

Key investigation commands and tools:

System	Investigation Approach
Network outage	Check Palo Alto Panorama > Dashboard; ping gateway from multiple segments; check ISP status
Okta outage	Okta Admin > System Log - look for policy errors, auth failures
Microsoft 365	M365 Admin > Service Health > check affected workloads; run Microsoft Support and Recovery Assistant (SaRA)
CrowdStrike	Falcon console > Event Search; check if detections are mass-scope
Intune	Intune > Tenant Status > Service Health

Step 8. Update Ticket Every 30 Minutes

The Scribe must add a timestamped update to the INC ticket every 30 minutes minimum:

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[HH:MM ET] Technical Lead investigating [component]. Current hypothesis: [X].  
Next update: [HH:MM ET].
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Step 9. Stakeholder Communications (Communications Lead)

Per the schedule in major-incident-communication-plan.md:

1. At T+15 min: Initial notification to IT leadership (CTO, IT Director) via Slack DM or phone.
2. At T+30 min: User-facing update posted to Slack [#announcements](#) and the Summit IT status page (<https://status.summitit.com>).
3. Every 60 minutes thereafter: Updated stakeholder email or Slack post.

Template for user-facing update:

```
[HH:MM ET] UPDATE - [INC-#####]  
Service: [Service Name]  
Status: Investigating / Identified / Monitoring  
Impact: [Brief impact description]  
Next update: [time]  
- Summit IT Service Desk
```

Phase 3: Resolution & Recovery

Step 10. Implement the Fix

1. Technical Lead proposes remediation. IC approves before implementation.
2. For changes during a P1: emergency change approval is granted by IC verbally and documented in the ticket. No CAB required during active P1, but the change must be retrospectively submitted as an Emergency Change within 24 hours.
3. Implement fix. Scribe logs every action with timestamp.

Step 11. Verify Resolution

1. Technical Lead confirms the fix is in place.
2. Test the affected service from at least 3 different user accounts or endpoints.
3. Check monitoring dashboards - alert conditions clear.
4. Confirm with a sample of affected users (2-3 reports minimum) that the service is restored.

Step 12. Declare Resolution

1. IC declares the P1 resolved on the bridge call.
 2. Update INC ticket: status -> **Resolved**; resolution details entered.
 3. Post resolution in Slack [#it-major-incidents](#) and [#announcements](#): [HH:MM ET] **RESOLVED** - [INC-#####] [Service Name] has been restored as of [HH:MM ET]. Root cause: [brief]. Full post-incident review to follow. Thank you for your patience. - Summit IT Service Desk
 4. Update status page (<https://status.summitit.com>) to **Resolved**.
 5. Send all-clear email to stakeholders (CTO, IT Director, affected department heads).
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Phase 4: Post-Incident Review (PIR)

Step 13. Schedule the PIR

Within **2 business days** of resolution: 1. IC schedules a 60-minute PIR meeting with all incident responders + relevant stakeholders. 2. Invite: CTO, IT Director, Technical Lead, Communications Lead, Scribe, SOC (if security-related).

Step 14. Complete the PIR Document

The PIR document must be created in the SummitDesk knowledge base within **5 business days** and includes:

Section	Content
Incident summary	What happened, when, impact scope
Timeline	Chronological log from detection to resolution
Root cause	Technical root cause (5 Whys if applicable)
Contributing factors	What made this worse or harder to detect
What went well	Recognition of effective response
What went wrong	Gaps in process, tooling, or communication
Action items	Specific, assigned, time-bound remediation tasks

P1 Communication Timeline Summary

Time	Action	Owner
T+0	P1 declared; INC ticket created	First responder
T+5	Bridge call opened; #it-major-incidents posted	First responder
T+15	IC acknowledged; Slack #it-help user notice posted	IC / Comms Lead
T+15	IT leadership notified	Comms Lead

T+30	First user-facing update (Slack + status page)	Comms Lead
T+60	Second stakeholder update	Comms Lead
Every 60 min	Ongoing updates until resolved	Comms Lead
Resolution	Resolution announcement - all channels	IC / Comms Lead
T+48 hrs	PIR scheduled	IC
T+5 biz days	PIR document published	IC

Verification

Check	Expected Result
INC ticket	Priority P1; timestamps logged every 30 min; resolution documented
Status page	Updated to Resolved
Stakeholder comms	Sent within timelines above
PIR scheduled	Meeting on calendar within 2 business days

Escalation

Condition	Action
IC does not acknowledge within 15 min	Escalate to L3 on-call manager: +1 (800) 555-7866 x2
Security event (ransomware, breach)	Immediately notify CISO: ciso@summitit.com; engage SOC; may trigger legal/regulatory notification
Vendor-caused outage with no ETA	Open vendor P1 support case (see vendor-support-contacts.md); escalate to vendor TAM

Media / external inquiry about outage	Refer all external queries to Communications / PR - IT staff do not speak to press
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